

LARRY EDELMAN

TRENDLINES

The economic damage is already done

It was the pause that failed to refresh.

President Trump may have avoided economic disaster Wednesday when he put “reciprocal” tariffs on hold for scores of countries. But his attempt to isolate the United States behind a massive tariff wall has inflicted significant — perhaps permanent — damage nonetheless.

After a day spent assessing Trump’s sudden about-face, investors on Thursday sent stocks into a renewed tailspin. An upbeat inflation report wasn’t nearly enough to prolong the

blistering rally the president had ignited Wednesday with a single social media post announcing his 90-day suspension of tariffs that had taken effect just hours earlier.

Why? First, Trump kept other new import taxes in place that will put upward pressure on prices. He has also undermined trust in the United States as an ally — and as a safe place to invest. And he escalated the trade fight with China, which is unlikely to back down.

The ill-conceived battle over

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US, China division putting global trade system on brink

As each side pushes back with harsh tariffs, analysts predict ‘a monumental train wreck breakup’ ahead

By Daisuke Wakabayashi, Alexandra Stevenson, Patricia Cohen, and Keith Bradsher
NEW YORK TIMES

A dizzying escalation of tariffs has unraveled a trade relationship between the United States and China forged over decades, jeopardizing the fate of two superpowers and threatening to drag down the world

economy.

The brinkmanship displayed by the two countries has already far exceeded the battles they waged during President Trump’s first term. In 2018 and 2019, Trump raised tariffs on China over 14 months. The latest escalation has played out mostly over a matter of days, with levies that are far greater and apply to a broader swath of goods.

On Wednesday, Trump countered China’s decision to match his 50 percent levy — a penalty for Beijing’s countermeasure to an earlier US tariff — with an additional duty, raising the rate on Chinese imports to at least 145 percent.

As hard as Trump has pushed, China has refused to back down. China has elevated its tariffs on goods imported from the US to 84 percent. It pledged again Thursday to “fight to the end,” an approach that is

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CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

Fourth grade Spanish language arts teacher Waldo Gomez laughed with his students during class at Kelly Elementary School in Chelsea.

SPEAKING THEIR LANGUAGE

Schools seek ways to connect with growing number of English learners

By Mandy McLaren and Christopher Huffaker
GLOBE STAFF

CHelsea — Reading aloud a novel to a class of fifth-graders, dark-rimmed glasses perched on the tip of her nose, Darby Drafts had fallen into a common teacher trap. Put simply, she was doing more work than the kids.

It was, however, a lesson plan driven by necessity. Reading the novel aloud enabled everybody to be on the same page, regardless of skill. And that was important for Drafts’s class of 23, which, by

this mid-February morning, included 18 students whose primary language was not English — eight of whom were newcomers learning English for the very first time.

Drafts, a Chelsea teacher with 17 years of experience, had never seen such a need.

“I’ve had kids coming all year,” she said matter-of-factly. “I got two in the last month.”

Across Massachusetts, a growing number of educators are finding themselves in similar positions. The state’s population of English learners has grown 25 percent since 2019, a dramatic uptick fueled by the large number of migrants arriving here

in the last several years. Fleeing violence and economic desolation in their home countries, families have landed in the Bay State, hoping to give their children a high-quality education.

Bringing those hopes to bear will require the state to rapidly improve its instruction, educators and advocates said. Achievement data underscore their concerns: Some two dozen other states, including high-poverty ones such as Kentucky, do a better job than Massachusetts at educating English learners, national test data show.

The results are partly, experts said, an enduring

ENGLISH LEARNERS, Page A8

Supreme Court backs migrant

Tells government to take steps toward his return

By Adam Liptak
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court on Thursday instructed the government to take steps to return a Salvadoran migrant it had wrongly deported to a notorious prison in El Salvador.

In an unsigned order, the court stopped short of ordering the return of the migrant, Kilmar Armando Abrego Garcia, indicating that courts may not have the power to require the executive branch to do so.

But the court endorsed part of a trial judge’s order that had required the government to “facilitate and effectuate the return” of Abrego Garcia.

“The order properly requires the government to ‘facilitate’ Abrego Garcia’s release from custody in El Salvador and to ensure that his case is handled as it would have been had he not been improperly sent to El Salvador,” the Supreme Court’s ruling said. “The intended scope of the term ‘effectuate’ in the district court’s order is, however, unclear, and may exceed the district court’s authority.”

The case will now return to the trial court, and it is not clear whether and when Abrego Garcia will be returned to the United States.

“The district court should clarify its directive, with due regard for the deference owed to the executive branch in the conduct of foreign affairs,” the Su-

SUPREME COURT, Page A6

Mining the depths of support for Read

Reporter finds onetime backers who switch sides like to stay below the radar

By Beth Teitell
GLOBE STAFF

The emails left me feeling scared, like I was hearing from people hiding from the mob.

“Thank you for having the courage to write about this,” one read.

REPORTER’S NOTEBOOK

“I have only told people in my close circle,” another said. “I’m a bit paranoid about personal info like my cell getting leaked,” a third worried.

And finally: “Be careful.”

Ho hum. Just another day in the Karen Read trial.

The correspondents were people who had once fervently believed in Read’s innocence, and, who, almost more importantly, had bonded with others in the trial’s grip. They spent their days hearing each other’s social media posts. Some had mustered outside the courthouse or on random roadways waving signs. Raised money for her defense fund. Or they wore the pink, they bought the merch.

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JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

A shadow was cast on a Karen Read banner during a protest at the Norfolk district attorney’s office last November.



Insiders

Friday: Rain, chilly.
High: 41-46. Low: 34-39.

Saturday: Windy, rainy.
High: 39-44. Low: 34-39.

Sunrise: 6:09 Sunset: 7:21

Comics and Weather, **G6-7.**

Obituaries, C11.

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VOL. 307, NO. 101

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00



Pierre Terjanian was named to be the next Ann and Graham Gund director and CEO of Boston’s Museum of Fine Arts. B1.

A New York City sightseeing helicopter broke apart in mid-air and crashed upside-down into the Hudson River, killing six people. A2.

Michael Levy resigned last week as the executive vice president and chief operating officer for the Corporation for Public Broadcasting. B5.

The Red Sox avoided being swept by Toronto with a 4-3 extra innings win. C1.